

TOPIC 7: LITERATURE – INTRODUCTION, PROSE AND ORAL LITERATURE

1. What is Literature?

Literature is written or spoken works of art that express ideas, feelings and experiences in an imaginative way. It includes prose, poetry and drama. Features include creativity, use of language, themes and emotional impact.

2. Types of Literature

- Oral literature (folktales, proverbs, songs, myths – passed by word of mouth).
- Written literature (novels, plays, poems).
- Other forms: historical accounts, dance drama, miming.

3. Purpose / Functions of Literature

To entertain, educate, preserve culture, teach morals, criticise society and develop imagination and language.

4. Introduction to Prose

Prose is ordinary written language (not poetry). Elements include: **plot** (sequence of events), **characterization** (how characters are presented), **style** (how the writer uses language), **setting** (time and place), **theme** (main idea or message). Study these in the recommended prose text.

5. Types of Oral Literature

Folktales, legends, myths, proverbs, riddles and praise songs. They teach lessons and reflect culture.

6. Summary

Literature is creative expression. Know its types, functions and the basic elements of prose and oral forms.

End of Topic 7